RURAL SOCIETY AND AGRARIAN CHANGE

JAJMANI ANATOMY → WHAT ACTUALLY DEFINED JAJMANI → DECLINE MECHANISM → AGRARIAN CLASS LADDER → DOMINANT CASTE TEST → TWO CATEGORIES KEPT APART

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 JAJMANI ANATOMY

JAJMANI ANATOMY · PATRON HOUSEHOLD, USUALLY LANDHOLDING · DESIGNATED HEREDITARY SERVICE GROUP · BARBERING, LAUNDRY, PRIESTLY, CARPENTRY, SMITHING · CUSTOMARY, OFTEN GRAIN OR KIND, SOMETIMES CASH · MUST REMEMBER · RURAL SOCIETY COMBINES CASTE, CLASS, LAND, LABOUR, CREDIT, KINSHIP

JAJMAN → patron household, usually landholding → KAMIN → designated hereditary service group → SERVICE → barbering, laundry, priestly, carpentry, smithing → PAYMENT → customary, often grain or kind, sometimes cash → MUST REMEMBER: Rural society combines caste, class, land, labour, credit, kinship, panchayat, market and state

CORE CLAIM
- JAJMAN → patron household, usually landholding
- KAMIN → designated hereditary service group

MECHANISM
- SERVICE → barbering, laundry, priestly, carpentry, smithing
- PAYMENT → customary, often grain or kind, sometimes cash

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Rural society combines caste, class, land, labour, credit, kinship, panchayat, market and state relations
- agrarian change follows tenure reform, Green Revolution, mechanisation, commercialisation, feminisation, migration, non-farm diversification and ecological stress.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Rural society combines caste, class, land, labour, credit, kinship, panchayat, market and state relations; agrarian change follows tenure reform, Green Revolution, mechanisation, commercialisation, feminisation, migration, non-farm diversification and ecological stress.

01

STAGE 01 WHAT ACTUALLY DEFINED JAJMANI

WHAT ACTUALLY DEFINED JAJMANI · THE ABSENCE OF CASH IN THE TRANSACTION · HEREDITARY ALLOCATION OF THE SERVICE ROLE · PERSONALISED PATRON-CLIENT OBLIGATION · CASTE OCCUPATION EMBEDDED IN THE VILLAGE ECONOMY

NOT → the absence of cash in the transaction

YES → hereditary allocation of the service role → YES → personalised patron-client obligation → YES → caste occupation embedded in the village economy

CORE CLAIM
- NOT → the absence of cash in the transaction
- YES → hereditary allocation of the service role

MECHANISM
- YES → personalised patron-client obligation
- YES → caste occupation embedded in the village economy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NOT → the absence of cash in the transaction
- YES → hereditary allocation of the service role

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: YES → caste occupation embedded in the village economy.

02

STAGE 02 DECLINE MECHANISM

DECLINE MECHANISM · PATRONS BUY SERVICES IN A MARKET · NON-FARM WORK · SERVICE CASTES MIGRATE TO TOWNS FOR WAGES · HEREDITARY OCCUPATION-CASTE LINK BREAKS · RITUAL AND PERSONALISED TIES SURVIVE IN PLACES

COMMERCIALISATION → patrons buy services in a market → NON-FARM WORK → service castes migrate to towns for wages → DECOUPLING → hereditary occupation-caste link breaks → RESIDUAL → ritual and personalised ties survive in places

CORE CLAIM
- COMMERCIALISATION → patrons buy services in a market
- NON-FARM WORK → service castes migrate to towns for wages

MECHANISM
- DECOUPLING → hereditary occupation-caste link breaks
- RESIDUAL → ritual and personalised ties survive in places

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COMMERCIALISATION → patrons buy services in a market
- NON-FARM WORK → service castes migrate to towns for wages

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESIDUAL → ritual and personalised ties survive in places.

03

STAGE 03 AGRARIAN CLASS LADDER

AGRARIAN CLASS LADDER · LANDOWNING CULTIVATOR · CONTROLS LAND AND SURPLUS · TENANT OR SHARECROPPER · CULTIVATES WITH INSECURE CLAIM · LANDLESS LABOURER · DEPENDS ON WAGE WORK · CLASS OFTEN BUT NOT ALWAYS TRACKS CASTE RANK

LANDOWNING CULTIVATOR → controls land and surplus

TENANT OR SHARECROPPER → cultivates with insecure claim → LANDLESS LABOURER → depends on wage work → OVERLAP → class often but not always tracks caste rank

CORE CLAIM
- LANDOWNING CULTIVATOR → controls land and surplus
- TENANT OR SHARECROPPER → cultivates with insecure claim

MECHANISM
- LANDLESS LABOURER → depends on wage work
- OVERLAP → class often but not always tracks caste rank

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LANDOWNING CULTIVATOR → controls land and surplus
- TENANT OR SHARECROPPER → cultivates with insecure claim

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OVERLAP → class often but not always tracks caste rank.

04

STAGE 04 DOMINANT CASTE TEST

DOMINANT CASTE TEST · LOCALLY NUMEROUS POPULATION · SIGNIFICANT SHARE OF VILLAGE LAND · CONTROL OF PANCHAYAT AND POLITICAL NETWORKS · LOCAL POWER CAN SIT BELOW THE RITUAL TOP

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NUMBERS → locally numerous population	OFFICE → control of Panchayat and political networks	NUMBERS → locally numerous population
LAND → significant share of village land	RESULT → local power can sit below the ritual top	LAND → significant share of village land

CORE CLAIM
- NUMBERS → locally numerous population
- LAND → significant share of village land

MECHANISM
- OFFICE → control of Panchayat and political networks
- RESULT → local power can sit below the ritual top

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NUMBERS → locally numerous population
- LAND → significant share of village land

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → local power can sit below the ritual top.

05

STAGE 05 TWO CATEGORIES KEPT APART

TWO CATEGORIES KEPT APART · DOMINANT CASTE · CASTE-LEVEL, NUMBERS PLUS LAND PLUS OFFICE · LANDOWNING CLASS · ECONOMIC CATEGORY CUTTING ACROSS CASTES · USUAL CASE · THE TWO LARGELY COINCIDE IN A VILLAGE · ERROR PREVENTED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DOMINANT CASTE → caste-level, numbers plus land plus office	ERROR PREVENTED → treating them as the same unit	Panchayati Raj representation is not the same as effective decision-making power.
LANDOWNING CLASS → economic category cutting across castes	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rural is not agricultural, landowner is not cultivator, farmer is not	
USUAL CASE → the two largely coincide in a village	only title-holder, productivity is not income, agricultural labour is not bonded labour, and	

CORE CLAIM
- DOMINANT CASTE → caste-level, numbers plus land plus office
- LANDOWNING CLASS → economic category cutting across castes
- USUAL CASE → the two largely coincide in a village

MECHANISM
- ERROR PREVENTED → treating them as the same unit
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rural is not agricultural, landowner is not cultivator, farmer is not
- only title-holder, productivity is not income, agricultural labour is not bonded labour, and

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- Panchayati Raj representation is not the same as effective decision-making power.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Panchayati Raj representation is not the same as effective decision-making power.

06

STAGE 06 GREEN REVOLUTION DIFFERENTIATION

GREEN REVOLUTION DIFFERENTIATION · INPUT PACKAGE · HIGH-YIELDING SEED, IRRIGATION, FERTILISER · UPFRONT CAPITAL, CREDIT AND MARKET ACCESS · EARLIER ADOPTERS CAPTURE A LARGER SHARE OF GAINS · OUTCOME VARIES BY CROP, TENANCY AND REGION

INPUT PACKAGE → high-yielding seed, irrigation, fertiliser → REQUIREMENT → upfront capital, credit and market access → EFFECT → earlier adopters capture a larger share of gains → LIMIT → outcome varies by crop, tenancy and region

CORE CLAIM
- INPUT PACKAGE → high-yielding seed, irrigation, fertiliser
- REQUIREMENT → upfront capital, credit and market access

MECHANISM
- EFFECT → earlier adopters capture a larger share of gains
- LIMIT → outcome varies by crop, tenancy and region

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- INPUT PACKAGE → high-yielding seed, irrigation, fertiliser
- REQUIREMENT → upfront capital, credit and market access

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → outcome varies by crop, tenancy and region.

07

STAGE 07 PANCHAYAT POWER TEST

PANCHAYAT POWER TEST · RESERVED SEAT · SCHEDULED CASTES, SCHEDULED TRIBES AND WOMEN · WHO SETS THE AGENDA IN PRACTICE · PROXY RISK · INFORMAL DOMINANT-CASTE NETWORK CONTROLS DECISIONS · EVIDENCE NEEDED · VILLAGE-LEVEL, NOT A NATIONAL STATISTIC

RESERVED SEAT → Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women

QUESTION → who sets the agenda in practice → PROXY RISK → informal dominant-caste network controls decisions → EVIDENCE NEEDED → village-level, not a national statistic

CORE CLAIM
- RESERVED SEAT → Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women
- QUESTION → who sets the agenda in practice

MECHANISM
- PROXY RISK → informal dominant-caste network controls decisions
- EVIDENCE NEEDED → village-level, not a national statistic

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RESERVED SEAT → Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women
- QUESTION → who sets the agenda in practice

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE NEEDED → village-level, not a national statistic.

08

STAGE 08 CONTINUUM AGAINST DICHOTOMY

CONTINUUM AGAINST DICHOTOMY · VILLAGE TRADITIONAL, TOWN MODERN, SEALED APART · ONE SPECTRUM LINKED BY FLOWS · MIGRATION, REMITTANCE, TRADE, MEDIA, ROAD AND MARKET · LINKAGE DOES NOT ABOLISH REMOTENESS OR LAND RELATIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DICHOTOMY → village traditional, town modern, sealed apart	FLOWS → migration, remittance, trade, media, road and market	DICHOTOMY → village traditional, town modern, sealed apart
CONTINUUM → one spectrum linked by flows	CAUTION → linkage does not abolish remoteness or land relations	CONTINUUM → one spectrum linked by flows

CORE CLAIM
- DICHOTOMY → village traditional, town modern, sealed apart
- CONTINUUM → one spectrum linked by flows

MECHANISM
- FLOWS → migration, remittance, trade, media, road and market
- CAUTION → linkage does not abolish remoteness or land relations

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DICHOTOMY → village traditional, town modern, sealed apart
- CONTINUUM → one spectrum linked by flows

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → linkage does not abolish remoteness or land relations.

09

STAGE 09 SCOPE DISCIPLINE

SCOPE DISCIPLINE · SOCIETY OWNS · JAJMANI, DOMINANCE, STRATIFICATION, CONTINUUM · ECONOMY OWNS · LAND CEILING, TENANCY LAW, POVERTY AGGREGATES · GOVERNANCE OWNS · PANCHAYATI RAJ INSTITUTIONAL DESIGN · CROSS-REFER THE BORROWING AND LABEL IT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOCIETY OWNS → jajmani, dominance, stratification, continuum	GOVERNANCE OWNS → Panchayati Raj institutional design	SOCIETY OWNS → jajmani, dominance, stratification, continuum
ECONOMY OWNS → land ceiling, tenancy law, poverty aggregates	RULE → cross-refer the borrowing and label it	ECONOMY OWNS → land ceiling, tenancy law, poverty aggregates

CORE CLAIM
- SOCIETY OWNS → jajmani, dominance, stratification, continuum
- ECONOMY OWNS → land ceiling, tenancy law, poverty aggregates

MECHANISM
- GOVERNANCE OWNS → Panchayati Raj institutional design
- RULE → cross-refer the borrowing and label it

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SOCIETY OWNS → jajmani, dominance, stratification, continuum
- ECONOMY OWNS → land ceiling, tenancy law, poverty aggregates

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → cross-refer the borrowing and label it.

10

STAGE 10 MEASUREMENT BOUNDARY

MEASUREMENT BOUNDARY · PLFS 2023-24 · DATED RURAL WORKFORCE COMPARATOR · PLFS ANNUAL REPORT 2025 · RELEASED MARCH 2026, LATEST ROUND · JANUARY TO DECEMBER, NOT THE OLDER JULY TO JUNE · CANNOT PROVE JAJMANI DECLINE OR CASTE DOMINANCE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PLFS 2023-24 → dated rural workforce comparator	PERIOD → January to December, not the older July to June cycle	PLFS 2023-24 → dated rural workforce comparator
PLFS ANNUAL REPORT 2025 → released March 2026, latest round	LIMIT → cannot prove jajmani decline or caste dominance	PLFS ANNUAL REPORT 2025 → released March 2026, latest round

CORE CLAIM
- PLFS 2023-24 → dated rural workforce comparator
- PLFS ANNUAL REPORT 2025 → released March 2026, latest round

MECHANISM
- PERIOD → January to December, not the older July to June cycle
- LIMIT → cannot prove jajmani decline or caste dominance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PLFS 2023-24 → dated rural workforce comparator
- PLFS ANNUAL REPORT 2025 → released March 2026, latest round

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → cannot prove jajmani decline or caste dominance.

11

STAGE 11 RURAL ANSWER SPINE

RURAL ANSWER SPINE · NAME THE CHANGING POWER RELATION, NOT A VILLAGE PORTRAIT · JAJMANI CHANGE, CLASS STRUCTURE, DOMINANCE, PANCHAYAT · WHICH RESOURCE NOW CARRIES POWER IN THIS VILLAGE · CONTINUUM VERDICT WITH THE DATA AND SCOPE CAVEATS · EVIDENCE LIMIT · CONTRAST PUNJAB-HARYANA, EASTERN INDIA, DRYLAND DECCAN, PLANTATION, TRIBAL AND

OPEN → name the changing power relation, not a village portrait → BODY → jajmani change, class structure, dominance, Panchayat → FRAME → which resource now carries power in this village → CLOSE → continuum verdict with the data and scope caveats → EVIDENCE LIMIT: Contrast Punjab-Haryana, eastern India, dryland Deccan, plantation, tribal and peri-urban regions

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → name the changing power relation, not a village portrait
- BODY → jajmani change, class structure, dominance, Panchayat

MECHANISM
- FRAME → which resource now carries power in this village
- CLOSE → continuum verdict with the data and scope caveats

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Contrast Punjab-Haryana, eastern India, dryland Deccan, plantation, tribal and peri-urban regions
- use Agriculture Census, Situation Assessment and labour data with period/coverage labels, and treat technology-policy correlations as mechanisms requiring

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → continuum verdict with the data and scope caveats.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · PANCHAYATI RAJ RESERVATION (CROSS-LINKED, INSTITUTIONAL DESIGN IN GOVERNANCE) · LAND REFORM AND TENANCY SECURITY (CROSS-LINKED TO ECONOMY) · CEILING LAWS AND · SELF-HELP GROUP AND COOPERATIVE INSTITUTIONS · RURAL SHGS AND COOPERATIVES · BOUNDARY CASE 1 — JAJMANI PERSISTENCE · A REMOTE VILLAGE WHERE A FAMILY STILL CALLS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Panchayati Raj reservation (cross-linked, institutional design in Governance):
- CAUTION: Land reform and tenancy security (cross-linked to Economy): ceiling laws and
- CAUTION: Self-Help Group and cooperative institutions: rural SHGs and cooperatives
- CAUTION: Boundary case 1 — jajmani persistence: a remote village where a family still calls

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: Boundary case 2 — proxy sarpanch: a Panchayat where a reserved-seat woman
- CAUTION: Boundary case 3 — successful reservation outcome: a Panchayat where an SC-reserved
- CAUTION: Boundary case 4 — full rural-urban continuum: a village where most households have
- CAUTION: Aggregate-output-versus-distribution trade-off: Green Revolution-style

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: Reservation-compliance-versus-substantive-power gap: measuring reform success by
- CAUTION: Continuum-versus-residual-isolation tension: while the rural-urban continuum
- M.N. Srinivas's "dominant caste" concept and Rampura village fieldwork are the
- Jajmani commonly involved customary grain/in-kind payment, but cash and mixed forms

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels